

rpt.rpt.NEFS_C_MidA_AerialSurveys

Type Enterprise Geodatabase Feature Class

Tags NOAA, NEFS_C, Aerial Surveys, Marine Mammals, Whales, Mid Atlantic

Summary

This layer depicts transects from the NOAA-Northeast Fishery Science Center’s aerial surveys that are conducted from 2024-2027 in the Mid Atlantic area. This layer contains five separate track lines that make up NEFS_C’s survey effort for the entire MIDA area. These lines show only the planned routes for the aerial surveys and are displayed for planning and research coordination purposes. Realized routes can be found on <https://whalemap.org/>.

Description

This layer depicts planned transects from NOAA-Northeast Fishery Science Center’s aerial surveys conducted from 2024-2027 in the mid-Atlantic region. For details on the project and methodology, visit: <https://www.fisheries.noaa.gov/new-england-mid-atlantic/marine-mammal-protection/whale-and-dolphin-research-northeast#north-atlantic-right-whale-sighting-surveys> [](https://www.fisheries.noaa.gov/new-england-mid-atlantic/marine-mammal-protection/whale-and-dolphin-research-northeast#north-atlantic-right-whale-sighting-surveys); and the RWSC database project page: <https://database.rwsc.org/details?recordId=rec5rsRHi5cVbXmAk> [](https://database.rwsc.org/details?recordId=rec5rsRHi5cVbXmAk). Realized routes can be found on <https://whalemap.org/#map> [](https://whalemap.org/#map).

Credits

Tim Cole – NOAA NEFS_C [tim.cole@noaa.gov](https://mailto:tim.cole@noaa.gov)

Use limitations

There are no access and use limitations for this item.

Extent

West -76.000000 East -72.850000
North 40.507900 South 36.666667

Scale Range

Maximum (zoomed in) 1:5,000
Minimum (zoomed out) 1:150,000,000

Topics and Keywords ▶

Content type ⇌ Downloadable Data

Citation ▶

Title ⇌ rpt.rpt.NEFS_C_MidA_AerialSurveys

Presentation formats ⇌ digital map

Resource Details ▶

Dataset languages ⇌ English (UNITED STATES)
Dataset character set utf8 - 8 bit UCS Transfer Format

Status on-going
Spatial representation type ⇌ vector

Supplemental information
This layer depicts transects from NOAA-Northeast Fishery Science Center’s aerial surveys conducted from 2024-2027 in the mid-Atlantic region. The NEFS_C’s survey of the mid-Atlantic is split into five separate effort areas with individual track lines, although sometimes multiple areas are completed within a single outing. The areas include Northern New Jersey, New Jersey and Delaware, Maryland and Northern Virginia, Virginia Wedge, and Chesapeake Bay Entrance. Data collection focuses on six large whale species - blue, fin, sei, humpback, sperm, and North Atlantic right whales - but also includes opportunistic sightings of sea turtles and other marine animals. The objectives are: (1) to determine each whale species’ distribution and estimate density; (2) to determine each whale species’ monthly and seasonal occurrence; (3) to characterize the interannual variability of the whales’ distributions and densities; and (4) to record behavioral data of sighted whales as much as possible. Summaries will be publicly available as surveys progress.

These surveys are a continuation of the NEFS_C Right Whale Aerial Survey program that has been running since 1998. The program began with patrols of Great South Channel and transitioned in 2002 to systematic line surveys of the northeastern United States Exclusive Economic Zone from the Gulf of Maine to South of Martha’s Vineyard and Nantucket. In 2006, the program transitioned to box surveys in the Gulf of Maine and Southern New England in order to increase the number of right whales identified per flight hour. In 2018, box survey efforts began south of New England. These box surveys continued through 2023, with special attention to right whale aggregations within the boxes after 2016. In 2024 the surveys were extended to the current coverage and converted to the line surveys seen in the layer.

The survey team used a de Havilland Twin Otter aircraft flown at 750 to 1500 feet at 100-110 knots. The surveys in Northern New Jersey, New Jersey and Delaware, Maryland and Northern Virginia, Virginia Wedge and the Chesapeake Bay Entrance are run once a month from December to March.

These lines show only the planned routes for the aerial surveys and are displayed for planning and research coordination purposes. Realized routes can be found on <https://whalemap.org/>.

Processing environment ⇌ Microsoft Windows 10 Version 10.0 (Build 26200) ; Esri ArcGIS 13.7.0.1901

Credits
Tim Cole – NOAA NEFS_C [tim.cole@noaa.gov](https://mailto:tim.cole@noaa.gov)

ArcGIS item properties
Name ⇌ rpt.rpt.NEFS_C_MidA_AerialSurveys
Size ⇌ 0.000
Location ⇌ Server=rwsc-db-pg15.env.duke.edu; Service=sde:postgresql:rwsc-db-pg15.env.duke.edu; Database=rpt; User=rpt; Version=sde.DEFAULT
Access protocol ⇌ ArcSDE Connection

Extents ►

Extent
Geographic extent
Bounding rectangle
Extent type
Extent used for searching
West longitude -76.000000
East longitude -72.850000
North latitude 40.507900
South latitude 36.666667
Vertical extent
Minimum value ⇔ 0.000000
Maximum value ⇔ 0.000000
Extent in the item's coordinate system
westBL ⇔ -76.000000
eastBL ⇔ -72.850000
southBL ⇔ 36.666667
northBL ⇔ 40.507900
exTypeCode ⇔ Yes

Spatial Reference ►

ArcGIS coordinate system
Type ⇔ Geographic
Geographic coordinate reference ⇔ GCS_WGS_1984
Coordinate reference details ⇔
GeographicCoordinateSystem
WKID 4326
XOrigin -400
YOrigin -400
XYScale 1111948722.2222219
ZOrigin -100000
ZScale 10000
MOrigin -100000
MScale 10000
XYTolerance 8.983152841195215e-09
ZTolerance 0.001
MTolerance 0.001
HighPrecision true
LeftLongitude -180
LatestWKID 4326
WKT
GEOGCS["GCS_WGS_1984",DATUM["D_WGS_1984",SPHEROID["WGS_1984",6378137.0,298.257223563]],PRIMEM["Greenwich",0.0],UNIT["Degree",0.0174532925199433],AUTHORIT
Reference system identifier
Value ⇔ 4326
Codespace ⇔ EPSG
Version ⇔ 6.2(3.0.1)

Spatial Data Properties ►

Vector ►
Level of topology for this dataset ⇔ geometry only
Geometric objects
Feature class name rpt.rpt.NEFSC_MidA_AerialSurveys
Object type ⇔ composite
Object count ⇔ 5
ArcGIS Feature Class Properties ►
Feature class name rpt.rpt.NEFSC_MidA_AerialSurveys
Feature type ⇔ Simple
Geometry type ⇔ Polyline
Has topology ⇔ FALSE
Feature count ⇔ 5
Spatial index ⇔ TRUE
Linear referencing ⇔ TRUE

Distribution ►

Distribution format
Name ⇔ Enterprise Geodatabase Feature Class
Transfer options
Transfer size ⇔ 0.000

Fields ►

Details for object rpt.rpt.NEFS_MidA_AerialSurveys ▶

Type ↔ Feature Class
Row count ↔ 5

Field objectid ▶

Alias ↔ objectid
Data type ↔ OID
Width ↔ 4
Precision ↔ 10
Scale ↔ 0

Field description ↔
Internal feature number.

Description source ↔
Esri

Description of values ↔
Sequential unique whole numbers that are automatically generated.

Field Shape ▶

Alias ↔ shape
Data type ↔ Geometry
Width ↔ 8
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field description ↔
Feature geometry.

Description source ↔
Esri

Description of values ↔
Coordinates defining the features.

Field OPERATOR ▶

Alias ↔ OPERATOR
Data type ↔ String
Width ↔ 254
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field POC_EMAIL ▶

Alias ↔ POC_EMAIL
Data type ↔ String
Width ↔ 254
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field PROJECT_NA ▶

Alias ↔ PROJECT_NA
Data type ↔ String
Width ↔ 254
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field PATH_NAME ▶

Alias ↔ PATH_NAME
Data type ↔ String
Width ↔ 254
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field START_YEAR ▶

Alias ↔ START_YEAR
Data type ↔ Integer
Width ↔ 4
Precision ↔ 10
Scale ↔ 0

Field END_YEAR ▶

Alias ↔ END_YEAR
Data type ↔ Integer
Width ↔ 4
Precision ↔ 10
Scale ↔ 0

Field START_DATE ▶

Alias ↔ START_DATE
Data type ↔ String
Width ↔ 254
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field END_DATE ▶

Alias ↔ END_DATE
Data type ↔ String
Width ↔ 254
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field FREQUENCY ▶

Alias ↔ FREQUENCY
Data type ↔ String
Width ↔ 254
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field PROJECT_LI ▶

Alias ↔ PROJECT_LI
Data type ↔ String
Width ↔ 254
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field DATE_SUBMI ▶

Alias ↔ DATE_SUBMI
Data type ↔ Date
Width ↔ 8
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field DATE_ADDED ▶

Alias ↔ DATE_ADDED
Data type ↔ Date
Width ↔ 8
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field LAB ▶

Alias ↔ LAB
Data type ↔ String
Width ↔ 254
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Field st_length(shape) ▶

Alias ↔ st_length(shape)
Data type ↔ Double
Width ↔ 0
Precision ↔ 0
Scale ↔ 0

Metadata Details ▶

Metadata language ⇔ English (UNITED STATES)
Metadata character set ⇔ utf8 - 8 bit UCS Transfer Format

Scope of the data described by the metadata ⇔ dataset
Scope name ⇔ dataset

Last update ⇔ 2026-08-12

ArcGIS metadata properties

Metadata format ArcGIS 1.0
Standard or profile used to edit metadata FGDC

Created in ArcGIS for the item 2024-01-24 12:31:40
Last modified in ArcGIS for the item 2026-08-12 13:42:56

Automatic updates

Have been performed Yes
Last update 2026-08-12 13:42:56

Item location history

Item copied or moved 2024-01-24 12:31:40
From C:\Users\jozog\OneDrive - HDR, Inc\GIS\HDR_NARW_Aerial_Tracklines
To \\DZ7YXT3\C\$\Users\jozog\OneDrive - HDR, Inc\GIS\Aerial_for_Jackie\HDR_NARW_Aerial_Tracklines